someone in MS Branch was on the ball after all. As a result, we spent the whole of Veena's holidays packing and moving to Sukna, with a short detour to Pune to meet our friends and relatives. Both of us were upset because we had planned to do a lot of things together during this break. Veena had only joined me for brief stays during my various sojourns at Mhow and during the HC course, so we really hadn't explored Mhow and its surroundings, except for a visit to Mandu once. Shortly after reaching Sukna, Veena had to return, so we could not go around much, though we did manage a trip to Gangtok, where Devraj Anbu was commanding 17 Mtn Div, and to Kalimpong, where Abhay Krishna was commanding 27 Mtn Div, as part of my familiarization visit. All three of us were coursemates and we all later became Army Commanders. It would have been nostalgic to visit Darjeeling where we had spent those idyllic two months in 1986, but we could not organize that.

When I reported to the Corps, it was being commanded by Lt Gen Surendernath, 'Suri' to his friends, who left just a little bit later, to be replaced by Lt Gen KJ Singh, both of whom were from the Armoured Corps. For some reason, a large number of the 33 Corps Commanders were from the Armoured Corps, and I wondered why. This posting of mine to 33 Corps on the staff was only a stopgap arrangement before I was placed in command of a Division. Because of my Myanmar connection, my name had been put on a panel for posting as the Inspector General Assam Rifles (IGAR) (South) which looks after Manipur and also conducts the Indo-Myanmar Border Liaison Meetings (IMBLMs), which I used to attend from the Myanmar side. At the same time, the name of Maj Gen Rajeev Chopra was sent for IGAR (North), which looked after Nagaland. The stay at Sukna was only supposed

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